

Carolina already has the people. What's missing is the infrastructure between them.

Thousands of Carolina alumni would take a call from a student. Thousands of students would benefit from one. The difficult part has never been goodwill. It is finding the right person, giving the conversation a reason to happen, and keeping the relationship going after it.

What Mentable does

01**Activate**

Bring alumni and students into one place by invitation.

02**Match**

Pair on what a student needs and where an alum can genuinely help.

03**Structure**

Goals, conversations and next steps live with the relationship.

04**Accountability**

Each conversation ends with something specific to do.

05**Measure**

Program leads see participation and momentum, never private messages.

How a Carolina deployment could work

- Alumni volunteer and say what they can actually help someone navigate.
- Students apply or are invited into a named program.
- Matches are made deliberately, by a person, at this size.
- Every relationship gets goals, sessions and agreed next steps.
- Program leads see whether it is working without reading conversations.

One layer, several communities

A single installation can run more than one program at once, each with its own participants and its own lead:

- Alumni and current students
- Family business
- Entrepreneurship
- Finance and competitive recruiting
- First-generation students
- Veterans

What Carolina would learn

- Who actually participates, on both sides
- Whether matches turn into conversations
- Whether students follow through between them
- Where relationships stall, early enough to intervene
- What participants say they got out of it
- Whether students come back later as mentors

A possible pilot

Start deliberately small: one program, one semester, a number of pairs small enough that every match is made by hand and every relationship is watched closely. The point of a first program is not scale. It is finding out what actually happens, with enough structure to know.